ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 4: **Vitamin-M; I Cannot Remember My Mother** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** memory	The 'M' stands for memory.
2	**(c)** respected and trusted	They have dignity.
3	**(a)** hearing, smell and sight	Tune, scent, sky.
4	**(d)** bonds with the older generation and the past	Grandfather and mother.
5	**(d)** he is old and needs care	The family looks after him.
6	**(c)** forgetful	Not paying attention.
7	**(d)** no longer with him	He cannot remember her.
8	**(d)** keep an eye on Grandpa when he goes out	She fears Grandpa will get lost.
9	**(d)** a third-person narrator	Narrated in third person.
10	**(c)** sadly longing	Longing.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	'M' stands for memory (1). The mother wishes for a vitamin to improve memory (1).	1+1
12	She had forgotten his birthday (1) so the joke about forgetfulness turns on her (1).	1+1
13	Rabindranath Tagore (1), a Nobel Prize winning Indian poet (1).	1+1
14	She fears Grandpa may forget his way (1) and wants him to be safe (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Grandpa is fond of Ravi (1). He teases him playfully (1). Ravi respects him and is protective (1).	1+1+1
16	Anxious about getting lost (1). Excited like a detective (1). Relieved on reaching home (1).	1+1+1
17	It sounds like a child's voice (1). It adds tenderness (1). It makes the feeling sincere (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Ravi hides awkwardly (1). Grandpa's calm walk contrasts with his worry (1). Small mishaps add fun (1).	1+1+1
18	It is catchy and funny (1). It points to memory (1). It becomes ironic at the end (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Memories remain in small things (1). Nature reminds him (1). Love lives in the heart (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Independent and sharp (1). Humorous (1). Hurt by being treated as weak (1). Loving towards Ravi (1). A figure of dignity (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Her worry (1). His reply (1). Compromise (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
20	Obedient and caring (1). Curious and playful (1). Afraid yet determined (1). Learns a lesson (1). A loving grandson (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Idea: love and loss (1). Tune (1). Scent (1). Sky (1). Mood of longing (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Reading 'Vitamin-M' as a story about a real vitamin. The 'M' stands for **memory**; the story is humorous and affectionate and is told by a third-person narrator.
- Missing the irony: Mother worries that Grandpa may forget his way, but it is Mother who forgot **Grandpa's birthday**. Naming Ravi or Grandpa as the one needing Vitamin-M loses the mark.
- Describing Ravi's secret following as rude or cruel. He hides behind benches and trees because he is worried about Grandpa, so state the motive (concern) along with the action.
- Mixing the poem with the story: 'I Cannot Remember My Mother' is by **Rabindranath Tagore**; its mood is tender and wistful, and the shiuli flower and the tune bring only a faint memory.
- Writing that the speaker of the poem hates or has forgotten his mother. He *cannot remember* her because she is no longer with him, so the feeling is loss, not anger.
- Tense errors: *Grandpa **had gone** out without telling anyone* (past perfect), not 'had went'. Plural of child is *children*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 4: **Vitamin-M; I Cannot Remember My Mother** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** following Grandpa secretly	He trails Grandpa unseen.
2	**(c)** had forgotten something important	She forgot the birthday.
3	**(d)** love and memory	A mother's presence.
4	**(d)** forgetful at times	She thinks his memory is weak.
5	**(b)** funny	Funny.
6	**(a)** Grandpa had gone out without telling anyone.	Past perfect.
7	**(d)** independence	He values his freedom.
8	**(a)** mother	Title.
9	**(c)** Mother told Ravi to follow Grandpa.	Command becomes infinitive.
10	**(a)** Ravi's mother, who forgot his birthday	Mother had forgotten Grandpa's birthday.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Mother thinks Grandpa needs help with memory (1) but she is the one who forgot (1).	1+1
12	Through a tune and a scent (1) and the colour of the sky (1).	1+1
13	He hides behind benches and trees (1) and keeps a distance (1).	1+1
14	He is clever and humorous (1) and values his independence (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Elders and youngsters misjudge each other (1). The family treats Grandpa as weak (1). Understanding removes the gap (1).	1+1+1
16	Mother, not Grandpa, was the forgetful one (1). Grandpa has a sharp sense of humour (1). The family's assumption about old age was wrong (1).	1+1+1
17	Grandpa said that he was not a child (1). Present becomes past (1). 'I' becomes 'he' (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He is an adult with a mind of his own (1). Rules make him feel helpless (1). He wants dignity (1).	1+1+1
18	A child who lost his mother (1). He feels her in a tune and a scent (1). It is a tribute to a mother's love (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Ravi was afraid but he followed Grandpa (1). 'But' joins two main clauses (1). The meaning of contrast remains (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Mother wishes for a vitamin (1). Grandpa goes out (1). Ravi follows (1). Comic incidents on the way (1). Home and the birthday joke (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Theme (1). Senses and imagery (1). Simple language (1). Tone (1). Personal response (1).	2+2+1
20	Title irony (1). Mother forgetting (1). Ravi's detective act (1). Grandpa's calm trick (1). The birthday joke ending (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Introduction (1). Grandpa's dignity (1). Family's mistake (1). Lessons (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Reading 'Vitamin-M' as a story about a real vitamin. The 'M' stands for **memory**; the story is humorous and affectionate and is told by a third-person narrator.
- Missing the irony: Mother worries that Grandpa may forget his way, but it is Mother who forgot **Grandpa's birthday**. Naming Ravi or Grandpa as the one needing Vitamin-M loses the mark.
- Describing Ravi's secret following as rude or cruel. He hides behind benches and trees because he is worried about Grandpa, so state the motive (concern) along with the action.
- Mixing the poem with the story: 'I Cannot Remember My Mother' is by **Rabindranath Tagore**; its mood is tender and wistful, and the shiuli flower and the tune bring only a faint memory.

- Writing that the speaker of the poem hates or has forgotten his mother. He *cannot remember* her because she is no longer with him, so the feeling is loss, not anger.
- Tense errors: *Grandpa **had gone** out without telling anyone* (past perfect), not 'had went'. Plural of child is *children*.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 4: **Vitamin-M; I Cannot Remember My Mother** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** a tune, a scent and the sky	Small things stir memory.
2	**(a)** mindful	Mindful.
3	**(c)** it is the mother who forgets, not Grandpa	The 'forgetful' one is not Grandpa.
4	**(a)** a trace of the mother lingers in memory	A faint memory.
5	**(b)** weak	Weak.
6	**(c)** sharp and humorous	He outwits the family.
7	**(a)** flower	A fragrant autumn flower.
8	**(d)** metaphor	No 'like' or 'as'.
9	**(b)** humorous and affectionate	Light and warm.
10	**(b)** tender and wistful	A gentle longing.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	His mother passed away when he was young (1) so only small traces remain (1).	1+1
12	They treat him as if he cannot manage (1) and hurt his independence (1).	1+1
13	They deserve respect (1) and trust, not overprotection (1).	1+1
14	Tender and wistful (1) full of love and loss (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	She frets about his memory (1). She herself forgets his birthday (1). The irony makes the story funny and wise (1).	1+1+1
16	Hearing: a tune (1). Smell: shiuli flowers (1). Sight: the sky (1).	1+1+1
17	Ravi had to keep an eye on Grandpa (1). The idiom means to watch carefully (1). It fits the plot (1).	1+1+1
	OR: That Grandpa is wiser than he looks (1). That trust matters (1). That the old should not be underestimated (1).	1+1+1
18	The poet recalls a lullaby (1). It floats in his mind while he plays (1). It is a faint memory of his mother (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Story: affection through humour (1). Poem: love through memory (1). Both value the older generation (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Respect the old (1). Trust them (1). Do not judge by age (1). Humour keeps bonds strong (1). Everyone forgets at times (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Story: memory as a joke and as strength (1). Poem: memory as longing (1). Both link memory to love (1). Both use small details (1). Different tones (1).	2+2+1
20	Date (1). Mother's request (1). The chase (1). The closing joke (1). His feelings (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Greeting (1). Recall the day (1). Express love (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

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- Tense errors: *Grandpa **had gone** out without telling anyone* (past perfect), not 'had went'. Plural of child is *children*.

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